

4D Competency Quick-Reference Card

AI Literacy for the Modern Workforce

ONE-PAGE REFERENCE
PRINT OR SAVE

- Delegation • ● Description
- Discernment • ● Diligence

The 4Ds describe four competencies for effective, responsible AI use at work. They operate in two loops: the Delegation–Diligence loop governs whether and when to use AI (strategic decisions); the Description–Discernment loop governs how to work with AI effectively (operational workflow).



DELEGATION–DILIGENCE LOOP

Should I use AI for this?



DESCRIPTION–DISCERNMENT LOOP

How do I work with AI effectively?

01 DELEGATION		
Deciding what work is appropriate for you, for AI, or for both.		
SUB-COMPONENT	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT YOU DO
Problem Awareness	Understanding your goals and the nature of the work before involving AI.	Define the task goal. Identify which components require human judgment and which are appropriate for AI assistance.
Platform Awareness	Understanding the capabilities and limitations of the AI tool you are using.	Identify what the tool generates reliably vs. where it systematically fails, before delegating.
Task Delegation	Distributing work between humans and AI to draw on the strengths of each.	Distinguish augmentation from automation. Decompose tasks by stakes, verifiability, and your domain expertise.

02 DESCRIPTION		
Communicating what you need from AI clearly enough to get a useful result.		
SUB-COMPONENT	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT YOU DO
Product Description	Defining what you want the output to look like.	Specify format, audience, length, detail level, and quality criteria before generating.
Process Description	Guiding how the AI should approach the task.	Provide methods, steps, constraints, and reasoning sequence. Give context, not single-turn directives.
Performance Description	Shaping how the AI behaves during the interaction.	Set expectations for tone, voice, directness, and priorities. Iterate rather than accept/discard first results.

03 DISCERNMENT		
Evaluating what AI gives you back before you use it.		
SUB-COMPONENT	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT YOU DO
Product Discernment	Evaluating whether the output meets your specification.	Verify factual claims, citations, and statistics against independent sources. Identify hallucination indicators.
Process Discernment	Evaluating whether the AI's reasoning is sound.	Check for logical gaps, unsupported assumptions, and circular reasoning. Trace the reasoning, not just the conclusion.
Performance Discernment	Evaluating whether the AI's behavior matched what you needed.	Assess whether tone, register, and style match the intended audience. Flag deviations from your instructions.

04 DILIGENCE		
Taking responsibility for what you do with AI and how you do it.		
SUB-COMPONENT	WHAT IT MEANS	WHAT YOU DO
Creation Diligence	Being thoughtful about which AI systems you use and how you interact with them.	Select appropriate tools for the task. Understand how your interaction patterns affect output quality.
Transparency Diligence	Being honest about AI's role in your work with everyone who needs to know.	Document which components were AI-generated, AI-assisted, or human-authored. Discuss practices openly.
Deployment Diligence	Verifying and vouching for the outputs you share.	Take full accountability before sharing. Apply the same review standard as work from a junior colleague.